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Are you wondering what happened to your order or payment, even after a fortnight? But did you mention your name and address clearly while sending payment, and what the payment was for?

We get several payments every month without adequate instructions or even identity of the person sending the payment. As a result we are unable to take appropriate action on these, till we get a complaint - if at all.

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Q1. What is a microprocessor? How is it useful to us?

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A1. Microprocessors are used in almost all electronic devices including computers, mobile phones, PDAs, digital video cameras and recorders. These are also used in vehicles and home appliances like washing machines, refrigerators, microwave ovens and coffee makers.

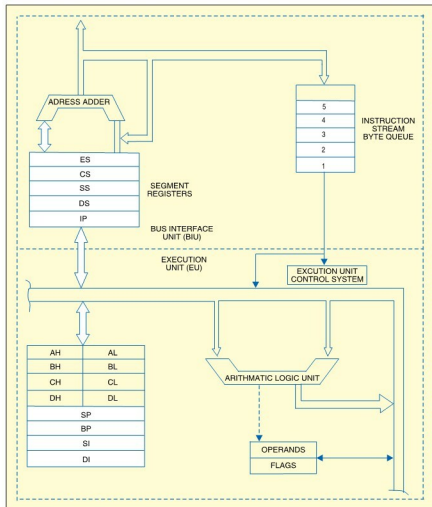
Basically, a microprocessor is a programmable digital electronic component that incorporates the functions of a central processing unit (CPU) on a single semiconducting integrated circuit. It is small (micro) and carries out computation (processor), hence called 'microprocessor.'

Microprocessors have the ability to:

1. Execute a stored set of instructions to carry out user-defined tasks
2. Access external memory chips to read and write data, from and to the memory

Microprocessors differ from micro-controllers in that these are general-purpose components, whereas micro-controllers integrate a microprocessor with peripheral devices for control of embedded systems.

The first microprocessors emerged in the early 1970s. The Intel 4004 is generally regarded as the first microprocessor. The size of the word was 4-bit. The processor worked with a clock of 746 kHz and was used for electronic calculators using binary-coded decimal (BCD) arithmetic. Now we have multi-core microprocessors with 64-bit word working at a clock rate of



Block diagram of 8086 microprocessor